

Question ID: 33b1b285

Question

Founded in 1965 and originally established as a cultural extension of the United Farm Workers—a union representing many Mexican American agricultural workers at the time—the theater troupe El Teatro Campesino has achieved recognition as a source of inspiration for subsequent Chicano theater companies and as a contributor to the dramatic arts. In an article about the company, a theater historian posits that a significant stylistic influence on El Teatro’s early performances was the audience-mediated slapstick comedy of *carpa* theater, vaudeville-style shows popular in Mexico and the US Southwest in the 1920s and ’30s.

Which quotation from the article would best illustrate the theater historian’s claim?

Answer

- A. “The company presented *actos*, short comedy sketches, that often relied on exaggerated physical humor to groups of agricultural workers, whose reactions—enthusiastic cheers of appreciation and, occasionally, loud boos of disapproval—promoted improvisation.”
- B. “The company was focused on the reality of the present situation and discovered that humor was often found in that reality; consequently, comedy became a tool to convey social critique while entertaining and inspiring audiences.”
- C. “The company relied heavily on satire, humor, and references to contemporary popular culture as well as a make-do aesthetic—often referred to as *rasquache*—that reflected not only the troupe’s limited financial resources but also its sociopolitical message.”
- D. “The members of the company, which in addition to founder Luis Valdez consisted entirely of nonprofessional actors, traveled into farm fields, where they, with minimal props and costumes, performed comedy in the form of brief humorous vignettes.”